

Daily Content Intel

June 16, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here's something I see done wrong with speed work all the time. Athletes throw a light sled on, knock out a few sprints, and figure they're building acceleration. They're kind of just sprinting with a parachute that doesn't open at that point.

A new study put adolescent sprinters through 8 weeks of heavy sled work, twice a week, and compared different loads. The light loads barely moved the needle on acceleration. The loads at 40 to 50 percent of body weight, those were the ones that improved the 30 meter sprint with a large effect.

Here's why that matters for a football or lacrosse player. The first 10 to 30 meters is where the game actually lives. That's beating a defender to the edge, closing a gap on defense, winning the ground ball. Acceleration is a strength quality, and to build it you have to give the body something heavy to push against.

So this week, if you're doing sled work for acceleration, load it up. 40 to 50 percent of body weight, short sprints, twice a week. Let it feel heavy. You'll feel the difference in how hard you can punch the ground.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If you want to get faster off the line, your sled needs to be heavier than you think.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here's something I see done wrong with speed work all the time. Athletes throw a

light sled on, knock out a few sprints, and figure they're building acceleration. They're kind of just sprinting with a parachute that doesn't open at that point.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Light sled = sprinting with a hat on
- 0:08 NEW STUDY: heavy sled, 2x/week, 8 weeks
- 0:18 40-50% body weight won. Large effect on 30m.
- 0:30 First 10-30m is where the game lives
- 0:45 Monday: 40-50% BW, short sprints, 2x/week
- 0:55 Punch the ground harder

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Most "speed work" I see isn't building speed. A light sled and a few reps feels productive, but it barely touches acceleration.

A new study ran adolescent sprinters through 8 weeks of sled sprints, twice a week, and the heavier loads won. 40 to 50 percent of body weight produced large improvements in the 30 meter sprint. The light loads? Barely moved.

For football and lacrosse, the first 10 to 30 meters is the whole game. Beating a man to the edge. Closing a gap. Winning the ground

ball. Acceleration is a strength quality, so train it like one and give the body something heavy to push against.

Load the sled. 40 to 50 percent of body weight, short sprints, twice a week.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.

threshold.clientsecure.me

#footballtraining #lacrosse #speedtraining
#sprintspeed #strengthandconditioning
#athletedevelopment #youthsports
#acceleration #sledtraining #thresholdhp

Personalize this

- What sled loads do you actually program for your HS football and lacrosse athletes right now, and how do you set them up without a force plate (bodyweight percentage, marked distances, hand timing)?
- Walk through a specific athlete who was "fast" in a straight line but lost every first step in a game, and what changed once you loaded the sled heavier.

- How do you fit heavy sled work into in-season vs offseason without frying the legs before practice or a game?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12771950/> | "Effects of different heavy sled loads sprint training on acceleration performance in adolescent sprinters"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12771950/> | "The 40%BM and 50%BM groups demonstrated significantly greater improvements compared to the NRS group"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12771950/> | "it is recommended that sled sprint training cycles be appropriately integrated into the training programs of adolescent sprinters and heavier loads resistance sprint training be employed to enhance acceleration performance"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12771950/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. Creatine is the most underrated tool for a high school athlete, and it has almost nothing to do with getting bigger.

Here's the situation. Your kid has school, practice, homework, a phone, and a social life, and they're sleeping maybe 6 hours when they need 9. They show up to practice fried. That under-recovery is the real performance problem most of the time.

A 2026 study loaded active men with 20 grams of creatine a day for a week, split into 4 doses, and they saw better sleep quality, sharper cognitive performance, more physical output, and less muscle soreness. The brain runs on the same energy system creatine supports, so when sleep is short, a full tank helps you think clearly and recover faster.

People still hear creatine and picture a bodybuilder. It's one of the most studied and safest supplements we have, and the upside for a busy, under-recovered athlete is real.

I'm not telling you to skip sleep and supplement your way out of it. Fix the sleep first. But if your athlete is grinding through a brutal stretch of the season, creatine is a smart, cheap insurance policy. Talk to your kid's doctor, then load it up.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your high school athlete is running on 6 hours of sleep, and the cheapest legal edge for that is sitting in the bodybuilding aisle.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. Creatine is the most underrated tool for a high school athlete, and it has almost nothing to do with getting bigger.

Here's the situation. Your kid has school, practice, homework, a phone, and a social life, and they're sleeping maybe 6 hours when they need 9. They show up to practice fried. That under-recovery is the real performance problem most of the time.

A 2026 study loaded active men with 20 grams of creatine a day for a week, split into 4 doses, and they saw better sleep quality, sharper cognitive performance, more physical output, and less muscle soreness. The brain runs on the same energy system creatine supports, so when sleep is short, a full tank helps you think clearly and recover faster.

People still hear creatine and picture a bodybuilder. It's one of the most studied and safest supplements we have, and the upside for a busy, under-recovered athlete is real.

I'm not telling you to skip sleep and supplement your way out of it. Fix the sleep first. But if your athlete is grinding through a brutal stretch of the season, creatine is a smart, cheap insurance policy. Talk to your kid's doctor, then load it up.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Creatine = the most underrated HS athlete tool
- 0:10 6 hrs sleep when they need 9 = fried
- 0:22 STUDY: 20g/day, 1 week, split 4 ways
- 0:30 Better sleep, sharper brain, less soreness
- 0:40 Same energy system the brain runs on
- 0:52 Fix sleep first. Then load it up.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Hot take: creatine is the most underrated tool for a high school athlete, and it barely has anything to do with getting bigger.

Most of these kids are running on 6 hours of sleep when they need 9. School, practice, homework, phone, social life. They show up to practice already fried, and that under-recovery is the real performance ceiling.

A 2026 study loaded active men with 20 grams of creatine a day for a week, split into 4 doses. They saw better subjective sleep quality, sharper cognitive performance, more physical output, and less muscle soreness. The brain runs on the same energy system creatine supports, so when sleep is short, a full tank helps the athlete think and recover.

Fix the sleep first. It's the foundation. But for an athlete grinding through a hard stretch of the season, creatine is a cheap, well-studied insurance policy. Loop in your kid's doctor, then start.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT It's time to cross your threshold.

threshold.clientsecure.me

#creatine #athleterecovery

#highschoolsports #footballtraining #lacrosse

#sportsnutrition #sleepandperformance

#youthathlete #strengthandconditioning

#thresholdhp

Personalize this

- When a parent asks you whether creatine is safe for their 16-year-old football or

lacrosse player, what's the exact conversation you have, and where do you draw the line?

- Talk about an athlete whose real problem was sleep and schedule, not training, and how you coached the recovery side before touching supplements.
- How does creatine fit into the recovery part of your CROSS framework for an in-season athlete, and what do you tell them to fix before they spend a dollar on supplements?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://www.nutraingredients.com/Article/2026/01/21/study-short-term-creatine-loading-provides-dual-recovery-and-performance-benefits/> | "Study: Short-term creatine loading provides dual recovery and performance benefits"
- physiology | <https://www.nutraingredients.com/Article/2026/01/21/study-short-term-creatine-loading-provides-dual-recovery-and-performance-benefits/> | "Supplementing with high-dose creatine monohydrate (CrM) for one week improved subjective

sleep quality, enhanced cognitive performance, increased physical output and reduced muscle soreness in active men."

- actionable | <https://www.nutraingredients.com/Article/2026/01/21/study-short-term-creatine-loading-provides-dual-recovery-and-performance-benefits/> | "Participants then underwent a seven-day loading phase, consuming 20 grams a day of either creatine monohydrate (Powder Pro Zero) or a corn-starch maltodextrin placebo, divided into four equal servings of 5 gram each."

Sources:

- <https://www.nutraingredients.com/Article/2026/01/21/study-short-term-creatine-loading-provides-dual-recovery-and-performance-benefits/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Combined Nordic + reverse Nordic hamstring work improved sprint, jump, change-of-direction and agility in young soccer players (Frontiers 2026, 10.3389/fspor.2026.1717594) — durability work that doubles as performance work.
- Single-dose creatine protecting cognition during sleep deprivation (revisit when the MDPI/Nature primaries are reachable).
- Resisted vs assisted sprint kinematics — pairing overspeed with heavy sleds across a block.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (2026-06-16): thin day. Mercola (autoimmune-in-women angle + microplastics, pure promo/scare, skipped per tone steer); Mike T. Nelson cert launch emails (Coaching Leverage framing, 8 interventions from protein to sleep, promotional, no citable primary). Nothing research-grounded with an athlete hook came out of the digest.

- PubMed / BMC Sports Science, Medicine & Rehabilitation: heavy-sled sprint loading in adolescent sprinters (PMC12771950) — picked for Draft A.
- Frontiers in Sports & Active Living (2026): combined Nordic + reverse Nordic in prepubertal soccer players (runner-up).
- NutraIngredients / creatine literature: short-term creatine loading, sleep, cognition, soreness (Jan 2026) — picked for Draft B.
- MDPI Nutrients single-dose creatine + sleep deprivation (2072-6643/18/8/1192): HTTP 403, unreachable, skipped.
- SimpliFaster "Myth of Speed Training and the Young Athlete": opinion piece, used for framing only, not cited.
- Dedup: checked cited-sources.json (25 entries, all within 90 days). Both chosen URLs are new. Topic families HRR, ACL clearance, deceleration/Nordic, per-meal protein, knee OA, ACSM guidelines already cited recently — avoided their exact URLs.